

Linux distro, Tails, leaves 32-bit architecture

Tails, the Linux-based distribution popular for its privacy features, is leaving the world of 32-bit architecture. Tails 3.0 will be the first version to support only 64-bit x86-64 compatible processors.

The developer team has announced that it decided to drop 32-bit support after analysing the statistical data of its users. "It is no surprise that over the last few years, the number of people who use Tails on a 32-bit computer has dropped," the team said in a statement, adding that at the beginning of 2016, only 4 per cent of Tail users were still using a 32-bit system.

There are many compatibility issues on Tails' Linux 32-bit version, which its developers have apparently spent a massive amount of time trying to fix. However, the team now wants to focus on more important priorities for 64-bit users.

The Tails team has highlighted two main reasons for opting for 64-bit architecture. First, the new hardware makes it harder for attackers to exploit security vulnerabilities. And, second, the Tails release using a 64-bit Linux kernel is supposed to be more sustainable in the long run.

Tails 3.0 with 64-bit support is scheduled to debut in June 2017. You can check if your computer is compatible with Tails 3.0 by typing 'uname-m' in the terminal window. The system generates 'x86_64' on the screen to confirm compatibility.

The live version of the Tails Linux distro can be run from an external read-only drive. The Debian-powered platform had gained massive popularity after it was found that whistleblower Edward Snowden used it to protect his identity from investigators in the US government.

machine learning system. I wanted to pick a popular game because I thought it might interest more people and expose them to how machine learning works," revealed Hughes. The combination of TensorFlow, cuDNN and some open source libraries has enabled Hughes to develop TensorKart's gameplay.

Hughes did face initial obstacles when he set out on his journey of providing a self-driving model in a video game. "I had to dust off my C programming skills and spend some time remembering all the nuances of C build systems and Makefiles," Hughes told *Open Source For You*, adding that he also faced initial issues in debugging the originally trained model when it was not moving the car correctly. However, Hughes took support from Stack Overflow and persevered after taking a day off in the middle of the project.

"When I first hit the issue of how to send input back to the emulator, I did not think it would be difficult. I needed to take a day off and appreciate this part of the problem and then approach it with the energy required to fix it properly," stated Hughes.

Hughes believes open source is the key to run innovations like TensorKart around the machine learning area. "I have been a believer of open source pretty much since. It became apparent early on how much more efficient open source was; it just felt right. I have benefited a lot from what others have shared and feel good to share my own work," he said.

Going forward, Hughes plans to expand his TensorKart with new developments. He also expects it to attract more people from the community.

Meanwhile, you can visit GitHub to download the same input plugin that has been enabling self-driving on Mario Kart and build your own advanced gaming experience.

Kodi 17.0 released with 10-foot interface

Team Kodi has announced the release of Kodi 17.0, a.k.a. Krypton. The updated media centre comes preloaded with a 10-foot interface and an enhanced user experience. Kodi 17.0 includes a new default skin called Estuary that has the traditional 10-foot interface. The interface enables the open source media centre to work specifically for televisions, with bold text and special controls for a simple handheld remote control.



For all touchscreen devices, the new Kodi release includes touch-enabled Estouchy. There is also Chorus 2 as the default Web interface.

Apart from the revised interface features, Kodi 17.0 has an upgraded video engine that has undergone a multi-phase rewrite. There are also improvements to stability, audio/video synchronisation, refresh rate switching and decoding/encoding of video. Additionally, the media centre comes with new input stream add-ons that extend support for streaming protocols such as RTMP, MPEG-DASH and SmoothStream.

Team Kodi has not just tweaked the video playback experience but also improved the audio output with performance improvements on tag scraping, support for mood and artist role tags, and increased browsing speed for larger libraries. The live TV and PVR functionality on the Kodi build has also received various improvements. There are now over 15 PVR add-ons and support for the Digital Devices Octopus Net, and asynchronous connections in the back-end.